capital invested in India is now greater than investments by either Japan and the United States, and although China has become India's largest trading partner, India is in no way economically dependent on China. In 2017, 5.1 percent of India's total exports went to China. In comparison, 18.5 percent of India's total exports went to the United States and its allies in Asia, Japan, and South Korea, and almost 10.6 percent went to the four major European countries Germany, the United Kingdom, France, and Italy.[119] Furthermore, India's withdrawal from the RCEP may be a sign that increased economic interaction with China may indeed also be a source of friction. The uncertainties related to Huawei's access to the Indian market may be an additional indicator that New Delhi is signalling an awareness of potential downsides of economic cooperation with China.

India has also intensified its high-level diplomatic engagement with China, both bilaterally as well as through regional and/or multilateral tracks. Although an increase in the number of meetings between officials and among policy-makers is a general trend in international diplomacy, the high frequency of meetings between India and China in recent years, particularly following the Doklam incident, reflects conscious Indian (and Chinese) attempts to improve relations. Koga argues that diplomacy is a weaker signal of alignment than are military and economic indicators, but that it is useful if neither military nor economic policies offer satisfactory signals of alignment behaviour.[120] After Doklam, New Delhi took a number of diplomatic initiatives to signal a wish for closer co-operation. The most important was, of course, Modi's attendance at the Wuhan Meeting with Xi Jinping in April 2018, but Modi's participation in the 2017 Russia–India–China trilateral meeting with Xi and Putin was also significant in signalling closer ties. Furthermore, following Doklam, Modi's government has toned down its